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Game Design Principles Identified and Where They Are Used:
I identified 3 different game design principles, which is risk vs reward, feedback looping and flow theory. For the risk vs reward part is the most common for modern games such as Dark Souls: the more difficulty the player chooses, the more reward they will get but at the same time the risk of dying and getting eliminated during the mission is much more higher. And the feedback loop I will use is the mobile game I’ve been playing lately “Slayer Legend” the more time players are online, the more rewards they will get, such as daily/weekly missions. And the flow theory I will use in “Celeste” means the principles require the player to keep in the flow where they need to feel challenged but not frustrated to keep playing at the same time.

Summary and Pros/Cons

Risk vs Reward Players balance risk and payoff. Pros: encourages strategic thinking and excitement. Cons: can frustrate casual players if failure feels too punishing.

Feedback Loops Systems where outcomes feed back into player power or progress. Pros: keeps players motivated and rewards mastery. Cons: can cause “snowball” effects where losing players fall too far behind.

Flow Theory Engagement peaks when difficulty matches ability. Pros: promotes immersion and satisfaction. Cons: hard to maintain for players with widely different skills.

How I Might Use (or Not Use) Each Principle

Risk vs Reward: In my card-battle game, players choose between safe and risky actions. This creates tension and strategic depth.

Feedback Loops: I’ll include light positive feedback and small bonuses for wins but minimal punishment for losses to keep play fair yet rewarding. Probably can’t be using my Texas Hold’em, but I can make a reward system where players keep logging in daily to get more chips.

Flow Theory: I’ll adjust enemy difficulty based on player performance, so beginners stay encouraged and skilled players stay challenged. For example the ELO system (Ranking)

Source used:
Csikszentmihalyi, M. (1990). *Flow: The Psychology of Optimal Experience.* Harper & Row**.**

AI used:
https://chatgpt.com/share/68e5dc1c-e990-8010-b21b-916a420d36e0